

***Version control* is the process of saving different versions of your project as it evolves. If you break a program, you can return to a previously working version, or you can simply examine how your program worked in a previous version.**

Version control systems work by allowing you to make a *commit*, which saves the current state of all the files in your project. You make a commit after implementing a new feature.

If you make a mistake and can't figure out how to fix your program, you can *check out* the previous commit and start again from a working version of your project.

A *repository* is the collection of all commits you've made to a project; it contains other resources required to manage your project as well.

A *distributed version control system* allows multiple people to make commits on the same project and provides tools for resolving conflicts in collaborative projects.

Git and Mercurial are the most common version control systems at the time of this writing.